Sears had Amazon's playbook. A century early.

Then it filed for bankruptcy.

A watch seller becomes a mail-order empire.

- **1886** Watches
- **1888** Catalog
- **1893** Sears, Roebuck

By 1894 the catalog sold sewing machines and baby carriages.

Watches

Sewing machines

Baby carriages

Insurance and credit too: Allstate and Discover.

1931

Allstate auto insurance

1985

Discover Card, nationwide

It built the world's tallest building.

1,454 ft

Sears Tower, Chicago, tallest in the world when completed

Then it stopped mailing the catalog.

Amazon opened online in July 1995.

Kmart buys Sears. Then Chapter 11.

- **1993** Catalog ends
- **2005** Kmart deal
- **2018** Chapter 11

Sears didn't lack the idea. It already had it.

> Remote ordering, delivery nationwide, credit, a trusted brand.

YOUR RULE

Protect the customer habit, not the format.

1. List what customers actually buy from you
2. Ask which format is fading
3. Test the new channel before you must

Share with your team ↓